

ToR chairs: D. Stevenson¹, L. Vansteenbrugge²
¹ NOAA AFSC, Seattle, USA
² ILVO, Vlaanderen, Belgium

Surveys are facing change

Long-term fisheries surveys are essential for providing data products used in fisheries management, conservation, and marine pollution. Changes to survey programmes have diverse impacts on survey effort affecting the reliability of survey data products, and the management strategies developed based on such products. WKUSER3, the third iteration of an ICES workshop focused on developing strategies to mitigate reduction in survey effort, produced guidelines for the implementation of survey change.

ToR1 of WKUSER3 focused on the preparation for change and built a roadmap outlining key steps to prepare a survey for change.

Key steps in the decision process:

- ❖ Clear characterisation of change
- ❖ Feedback loops when assessing impact of change
- ❖ Maintain stakeholder engagement to build trust

Research needs:

- ❖ Tools to quantify the benefits of survey change
- ❖ Definition of new data needs
- ❖ Identification of acceptable levels of uncertainty
- ❖ Impact of MPA/ORE on survey data products
- ❖ Accounting for surprise factors in simulations

Major/minor changes

A **major change** disrupts the survey time series or otherwise impacts the end survey product, such as abundance indices.

- Require short- and long-term resource allocation, communication and data management strategies, and research into the impact of the change.

Examples: changes to the survey design and/or gear

Minor changes do not necessarily disrupt the existing time series or existing data pipelines

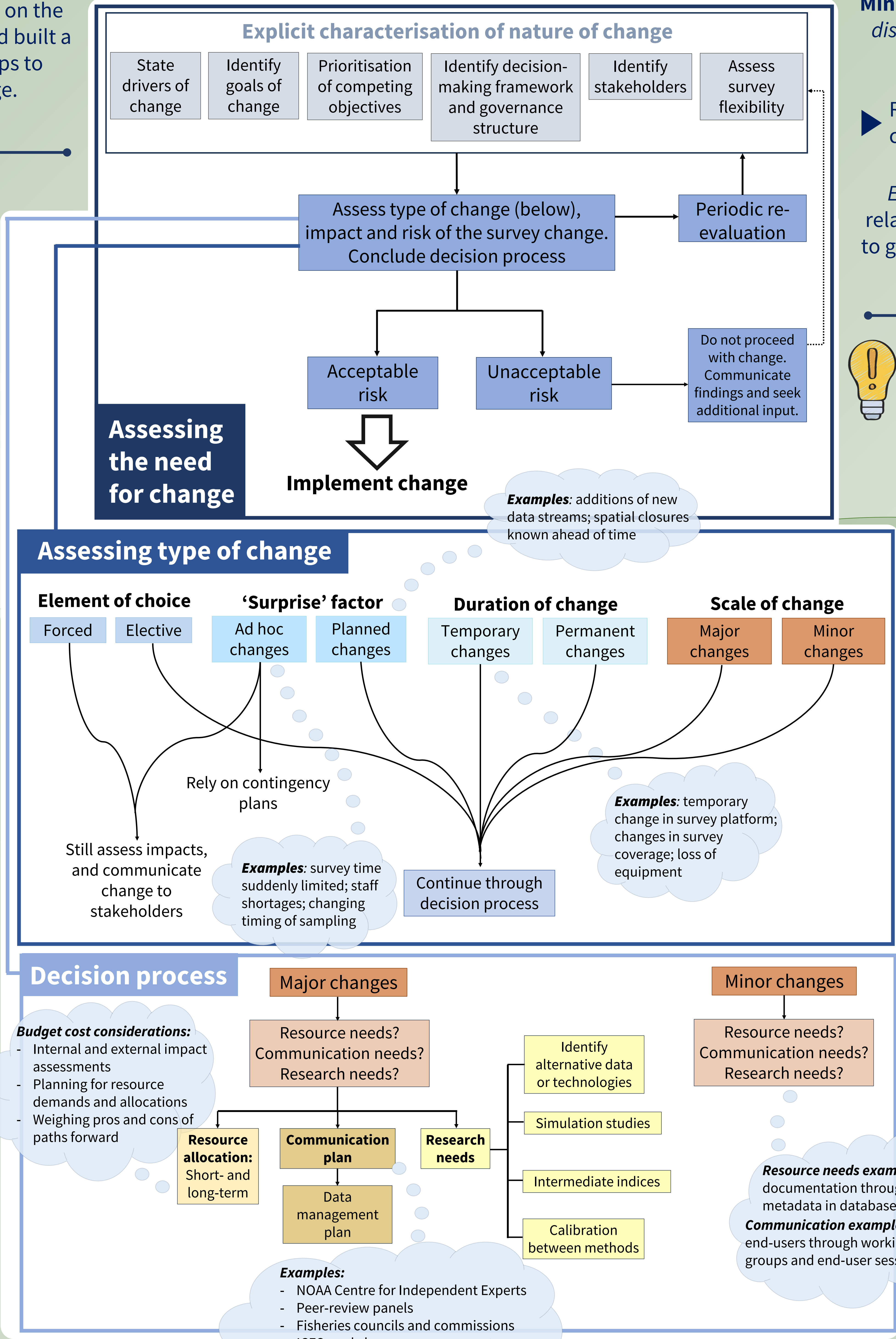
- Require documentation and clear communication.

Examples: operational changes related to weather, modifications to gear sensors, or other non-core data components.



Whether a change is major or minor, is **context-specific** and can vary with each survey.

Road map



Recommendations and prospects:

- ❖ **'cookbook' to converge existing analysis and simulation methods** across surveys
- ❖ Future workshop to **develop guidelines on procedure and tolerable thresholds of impact scale**

SCAN ME for the full report

